

Of Mice and Furmen Constitution

Mission Statement

“Of Mice and Furmen” strives to foster a community of people who enjoy exploring literature and discussing real world applications of literary themes. This organization hopes to provide an outlet for avid readers to regularly converse with people who share their passion for books.

Values Statement

“Of Mice and Furmen” highly values literacy, inclusion, the importance of discussion, and social/cultural awareness. By reading books and promoting a detailed discussion about cultural applications, we seek to instill these values in our members and lead them to consider and embody the importance of different perspectives.

Vision Statement

This book club hopes to spread enthusiasm about reading over Furman’s campus. By working alongside the Furman English Department and other various organizations, it aims to bring excitement back into both nonfiction and fiction literature, especially for those who seem weighed down by academic readings and wish to read for leisure again. In addition, through discussions, the club seeks to show its members the significance of others’ perspectives and how a piece of literature may have a meaning that is applicable to both society and an individual. Overall, it hopes to give the Furman community an outlet to discuss works of literature with others who will value and perhaps enhance their views.

Article I. Name of Organization

The name of this organization will be Of Mice and Furmen.

Article II. Membership

Section I.

The requirements for members of “Of Mice and Furmen” will include:

- A. Required attendance of one meeting per month (additional meetings may occur)
- B. A commitment to keeping up with the readings of the chosen book
- C. Willingness to participate and contribute to an educated discussion about thematic elements and cultural significance of the reading
- D. Members can purchase their own books or use provided copies from the club

Article III. Leadership

Section I.

Faculty advisor

- A. The advisor is required to read over or have previously read the selected book(s), attend a minimum of three meetings per semester, and help to provide professional and in-depth insight to book analysis and discussion. If the executive members or co-presidents need assistance with preparation for meetings, (e.g. generating discussion questions or analyzing books) the advisor will provide help as necessary.

Section II.

Co-presidents

- A. The co-presidents are in charge of creating a comprehensive book list from which the club members will choose two books each semester. Additionally, they have the responsibility of facilitating discussion among members by keeping others on topic, bringing up thoughtful discussion questions, and aiding the conversation flow. Lastly, the co-presidents have administrative duties that include scheduling the book club meetings, providing books to members as needed, and overseeing the operations of the rest of the leadership staff throughout the year.

Section III.

Treasurer

- A. The treasurer is required to plan a yearly budget and facilitate book purchases for all club members. He/she will also track all monetary transactions and communicate with SGA about budgetary details.

Section IV.

Publicity Manager

- A. The publicity manager is required to engage students through social media, create and distribute flyers across campus to raise awareness about club meetings and events, represent the organization at activity fairs, and update the organization's "Syncdin" page.

Article IV. Advisor Elections

The organization will obtain recommendations for a faculty advisor through club members. The co-presidents will hold a formal meeting with a potential advisor to discuss the advisor's interest in the position, enthusiasm and knowledge about literature, and availability to participate in club activities. After a two-thirds ($\frac{2}{3}$) vote by club members, the advisor will be officially appointed. The advisor will remain in this position until he/she chooses to leave or until he/she is no longer able to adequately contribute to the organization.

Article V. Leadership Removal and Replacement Processes

- A. For any member of the leadership team, three violations of leadership duties will result in that member being put on probation for a period of a month. These violations include: not attending all of the meetings (except one allowed absence), not participating in or helping to further book discussions, and not fulfilling the duties of their specific position that are outlined in Article III. If, after the probation period is over, that member still does not take his or her leadership duties seriously, the rest of the leadership team, including the advisor, will vote to remove that member.
- B. Any leadership vacancy, whether it be a removal or a leadership member who stepped down or graduated, will be filled by a club election. Elections will occur at the meeting immediately after the vacancy, if it occurs during the year. Otherwise, elections will occur at the beginning of each school year.
- C. Members are open to run for position in office, and members can nominate officers at any meeting. Fifty percent plus one of members must be present at the meeting for a vote to occur, and the results will be announced at the following meeting. The counting and handling of ballots will be the responsibility of the co-presidents. If the co-presidents are running for office, this responsibility will fall to the next ranking officer who is not on the ballot. Candidates running for co-presidents will run together on the same ballot. Candidates wishing to run alone may do so.
- D. Turnover for leadership positions will occur at the end of the spring semester. The book club will have a meeting dedicated to explaining the roles of each position to new leaders and helping to set up a plan for the following year.

Article VI. Meetings, Quorums, and Procedures

Meetings will occur at least once a month in a lounge or classroom that can be decided at a later date and will be open to all student body members. The club will vote on books from a provided list, created by the co-presidents, and the recommended pages to read will be discussed at each meeting. Voting will occur for decisions that affect all club members and will happen at the beginning of meetings. A two-thirds ($\frac{2}{3}$) majority vote from present members is required to pass a new policy or make a club decision.

Article VII. Amendments

Amendments will be presented at club meetings a week before they are to be voted on. In order to be passed, two-thirds of the club members must vote in favor of it.